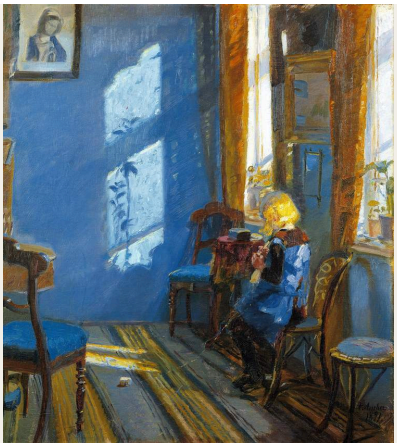
SKAGEN, DENMARK

Skagens Museum: Masterpieces

Twenty works that distinguish the labour, pauses and changing light of a coastal community.



The sea at Skagen can be a place to walk, a source of work or a field of colour with almost nobody in it. The contrast is visible within this selection: fishermen haul a net, two women follow the shore, and footprints remain after their maker has passed out of view. Inside, light can occupy a room as decisively as its inhabitants.

Anna Ancher, Krøyer and the other painters represented here do not make a uniform idyll. Work, rest, company and grief require different kinds of attention. These twenty pictures are best read as particular situations, not illustrations of a single atmosphere that every artist supposedly found in Skagen.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/skagens-museum

The selection · 20

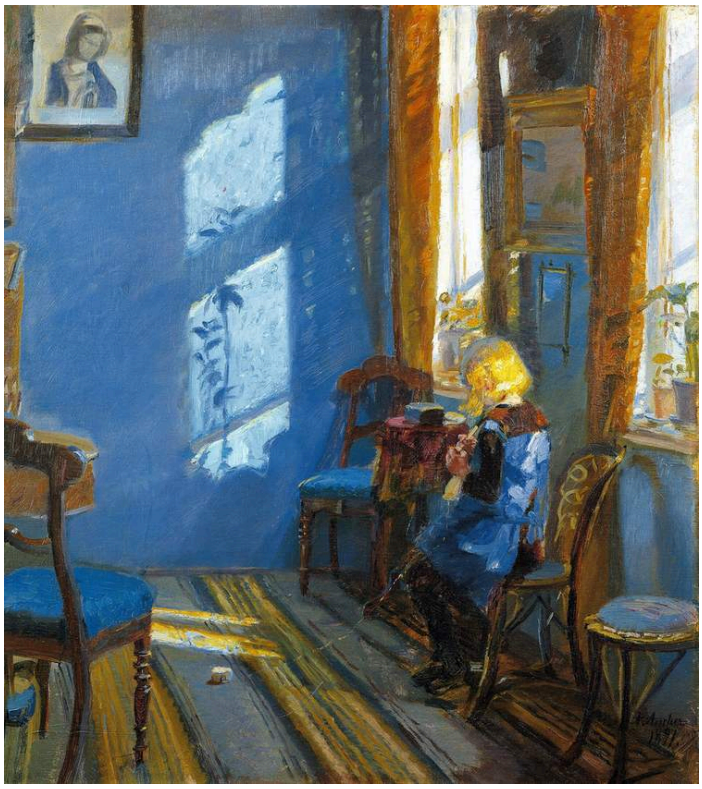
1. Sunlight in the Blue Room
   Anna Ancher · 1891
2. Summer Evening on Skagen Sønderstrand
   P. S. Krøyer · 1893
3. Fishermen Hauling the Net on Skagen's North Beach
   P. S. Krøyer · 1883
4. Harvesters
   Anna Ancher · 1905
5. Young Girl before a Lit Lamp
   Anna Ancher · 1887
6. Interior with Red Poppies
   Anna Ancher · 1905
7. Grief
   Anna Ancher · 1902
8. At the Grave
   Anna Ancher · 1913
9. Ane Hedvig Brøndum
   Anna Ancher · 1893
10. A Game of L'Hombre at Brøndum's Hotel
    Anna Palm de Rosa · 1885
11. Maren Sofie Olsen, a Young Woman from Skagen
    Michael Ancher · 1887
12. Dead Rays
    P. S. Krøyer · 1884
13. Fisherman Rasmus Gaihede's Afternoon Nap
    Christian Krohg · c. 1882
14. Footprints in the Sand
    P. S. Krøyer · 1883
15. Launching the Boat at Skagen
    Oscar Björck · 1884
16. Moonrise over the Dunes
    Eilif Peterssen · 1883
17. Skagen Sønderstrand on a Windy Day
    Oscar Björck · 1882–1888
18. Sunset at Skagen
    Michael Ancher · 1906
19. Two Fishermen Talking outside Brøndum's Hotel
    Christian Krohg · 1888
20. Vibeke Krøyer in the Plantation
    P. S. Krøyer · 1909

01 / 20

Sunlight in the Blue Room

Anna Ancher

1891 · Oil on canvas · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher, Sunlight in the Blue Room. Skagens Museum, Skagen. Reproduction via Wikimedia Commons (PD-Art). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression to at most 100,000 bytes; no crop or generated content. · Public Domain Mark 1.0 / PD-Art

The child's small presence does not prevent the sunlit wall from becoming the room's most insistent feature. Rectangles of light cross the blue surface and connect it to the floor and furniture. The museum identifies the child as Helga Ancher. Her concentration and the light belong to the same room without competing to explain one another.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

Summer Evening on Skagen Sønderstrand

P. S. Krøyer

1893 · Oil on canvas · Skagens Museum



P. S. Krøyer, Summer Evening on Skagen Sønderstrand. Skagens Museum, Skagen. Reproduction via Wikimedia Commons (PD-Art). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression to at most 100,000 bytes; no crop or generated content. · Public Domain Mark 1.0 / PD-Art

Two pale dresses establish a small companionship within the broad beach. The sea and sky approach one another in colour, so the shore's extent matters more than a sharply divided horizon. Walking supplies an event, but a restrained one. The figures inhabit the evening without turning it into a backdrop for conspicuous drama.

Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Fishermen Hauling the Net on Skagen’s North Beach

P. S. Krøyer

1883 · Skagens Museum



P. S. Krøyer. Fishermen Hauling the Net on Skagen's North Beach. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The men's backward lean makes the net's resistance visible even where the net itself is less prominent. Bent knees and extended arms repeat, but each body occupies a different point in the effort. The group works through coordination rather than identical poses, a distinction that gives collective labour a credible physical shape.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Harvesters

Anna Ancher

1905 · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. Harvesters. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The standing crop hides much of the workers' lower bodies, leaving tools and upper gestures to explain the activity. A lifted scythe cuts a long diagonal across the sky. The harvest is therefore described selectively: a few visible actions imply movements that continue behind the field's high, golden surface.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

Young Girl before a Lit Lamp

Anna Ancher

1887 · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. Young Girl Before a Lit Lamp. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The figure's turned back denies the easy explanation that a facial expression might seem to offer. Instead, the lamp's light joins her to the flowers, table and nearby window. The ordinary action remains open, while the small illuminated area gives the room a centre without disclosing a private thought.

Object source · Open artwork

06 / 20

Interior with Red Poppies

Anna Ancher

1905 · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. Interior with Red Poppies. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The red poppies claim attention in front of the sitter rather than merely decorating her portrait. Their colour connects the tabletop to the warmer room, while the green sofa provides a different surrounding field. The figure remains present, but the balance of the interior can be read through colour before it is read through a face.

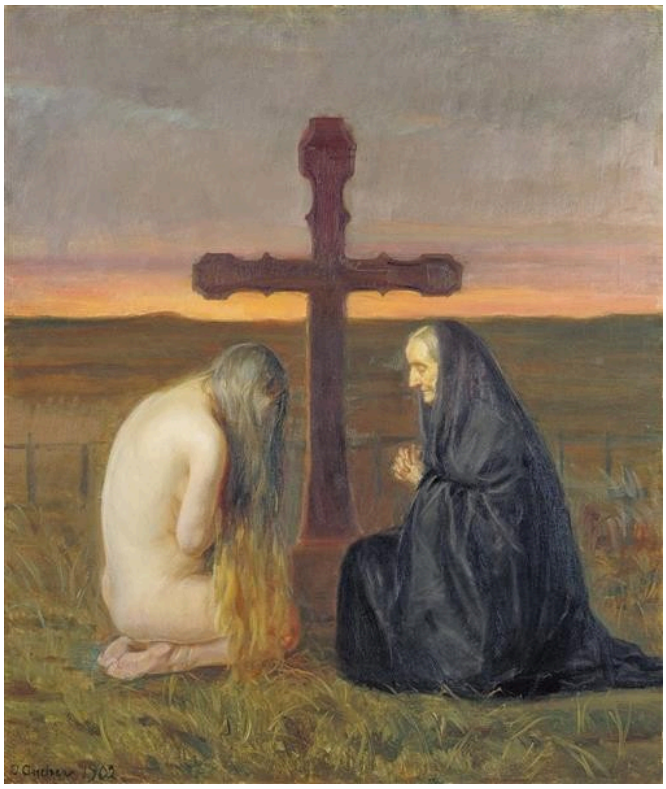
Object source · Open artwork

07 / 20

Grief

Anna Ancher

1902 · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. Grief. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The two kneeling women share a lowered posture but differ sharply in dress, one clothed and the other exposed. The grave cross joins them within an arrangement that exceeds an ordinary cemetery scene. The title identifies grief; the unusual pairing prevents it from being reduced to a single, familiar outward expression.

Object source · Open artwork

08 / 20

At the Grave

Anna Ancher

1913 · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. At the Grave. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The woman's narrow profile and gathered, lowered hands carry the scene with little overt action. Distant graves and sky remain less fully described, keeping attention near the seated body. Unlike the symbolic opposition of the two figures in *Grief*, this painting gives mourning the scale of one person occupying a place.

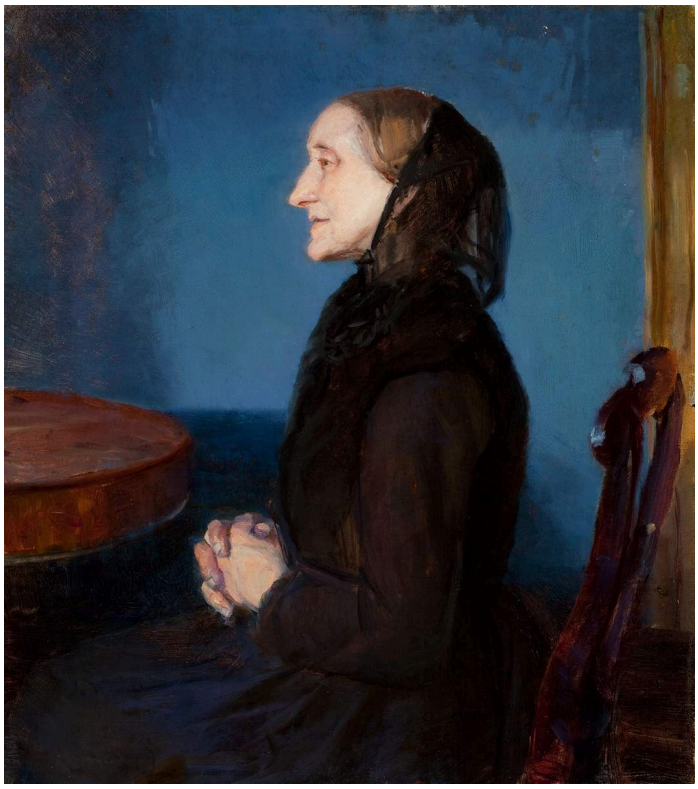
Object source · Open artwork

09 / 20

Ane Hedvig Brøndum

Anna Ancher

1893 · Oil · Skagens Museum



Anna Ancher. Portrait of Ane Hedvig Brøndum. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/anna-ancher/portrait-of-ane-hedvig-brondum · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The strong blue wall separates the sitter's profile while the table edge and hands return her to the dimensions of a room. Her presence is neither monumental nor detached from domestic objects. The portrait's particularity lies in this arrangement of body and surroundings, rather than in a general claim about the character of old age.

Object source · Open artwork

10 / 20

A Game of L’Hombre at Brøndum’s Hotel

Anna Palm de Rosa

1885 · Skagens Museum



Anna Palm de Rosa. A game of L'hombre in Brøndum's Hotel. Image credit: Anna Palm de Rosa; Source credit: PgGB34Or82p_fw at Google Cultural Institute , zoom level maximum. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The cards and illuminated faces form a close circle within the darker room. Smoke softens its outer boundary, making the game seem temporarily self-contained. The players' attention is shared without requiring the viewer to know the hand being played. A social activity becomes legible through the small area toward which the group converges.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 672

11 / 20

Maren Sofie Olsen, a Young Woman from Skagen

Michael Ancher

1887 · Skagens Museum



Michael Ancher. A young woman from Skagen, Maren Sofie Olsen. Image credit: Michael Ancher. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The plain warm ground leaves little explanation outside the sitter herself. Buttons, parted hair and the firm outline of the blue garment establish a composed front, while the eyes meet the outward view. The portrait gives a named local woman sustained attention without turning her into a generic representative of a fishing community.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1601

12 / 20

Dead Rays

P. S. Krøyer

1884 · Skagens Museum



Peder Severin Krøyer. Dead rays. Image credit: Peder Severin Krøyer. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The rays remain still while shallow water moves around their flat bodies. That contrast gives a close shore subject a different tempo from the fishermen's labour elsewhere in the selection. The pale surfaces also interrupt the wet sand, making the fish register as objects with weight and extent rather than incidental marks on a beach.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 118

13 / 20

Fisherman Rasmus Gaihede’s Afternoon Nap

Christian Krohg

c. 1882 · Skagens Museum



Christian Krohg. Fisherman Rasmus Gaihede's afternoon nap. Image credit: Christian Krohg. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The face turns toward the pillow, and the clothing settles into the broad shapes of the bedding. Here the fisherman is represented outside active work. The pause belongs to the same life as hauling and launching, but the picture does not need to invent a preceding event to make rest its sufficient subject.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SKM1018

14 / 20

Footprints in the Sand

P. S. Krøyer

1883 · Skagens Museum



Peder Severin Krøyer. Footprints in the sand. Image credit: Peder Severin Krøyer. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The tracks record a passage whose maker is no longer pictured. They lead attention across an otherwise sparse beach toward birds and low surf. The shore contains evidence of an action rather than the action itself, giving a modest set of marks more narrative weight than their physical size would suggest.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SKM2088

15 / 20

Launching the Boat at Skagen

Oscar Björck

1884 · Skagens Museum



Oscar Björck. Launching the Boat. Skagen. Image credit: Oscar Björck; Source credit: cgHGNr3Yl9yyZQ at Google Cultural Institute , zoom level maximum. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The boat's weight is measured through several bodies bent against its hull. Breaking water defines the place they are trying to reach, making the sea a working environment rather than an empty blue prospect. Their coordinated pushing links shore and vessel through an effort that a picture of the boat alone could not show.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1650

16 / 20

Moonrise over the Dunes

Eilif Peterssen

1883 · Skagens Museum



Eilif Peterssen. Moonrise over the dunes. Image credit: Eilif Peterssen; Source credit: 7AEbb_1VUcrmQA at Google Cultural Institute , zoom level maximum. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The moon provides one concentrated warm point above the dark vegetation. It does not illuminate everything around it, and the small figures remain near the limit of recognition. Peterssen lets darkness retain its extent. The landscape's organisation depends on what can be distinguished only gradually, rather than on a fully clarified view.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 658

17 / 20

Skagen Sønderstrand on a Windy Day

Oscar Björck

1882–1888 · Skagens Museum



Oscar Björck. Skagen Sønderstrand on a windy day.. Image credit: Oscar Björck; Source credit: skyfish.com. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The beached boat gives the narrow strip of shore a firm shape beneath the much larger sky. Small figures and surf occupy that same lower band, leaving air to determine the view's proportions. The unequal division makes the coast feel exposed without requiring the wind to be illustrated through a single conspicuous incident.

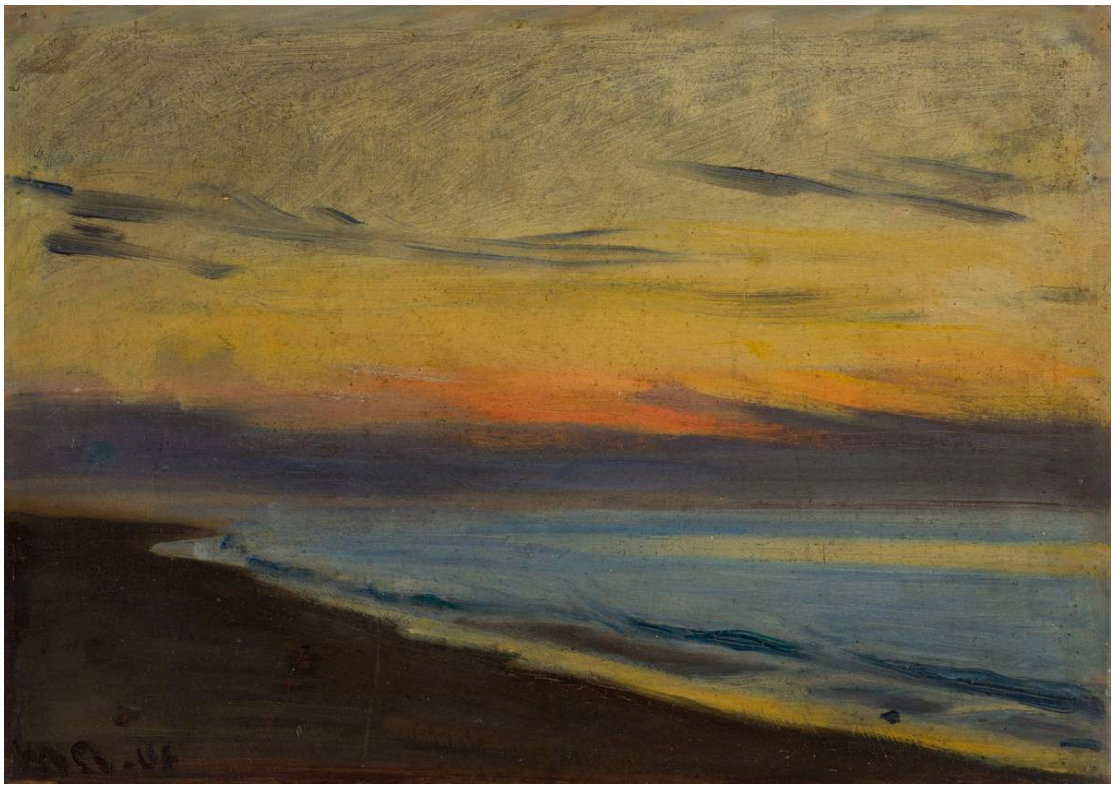
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SKM715

18 / 20

Sunset at Skagen

Michael Ancher

1906 · Skagens Museum



Michael Ancher. Sunset at Skagen. Image credit: Michael Ancher. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

A warm strip of sky separates darker shore and sea, with only sparse cloud marks interrupting the horizontal arrangement. The picture gives colour at a particular time of day priority over local incident. Without a large figure or boat to anchor the scene, the narrow meeting of water and air has to hold attention.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1145

19 / 20

Two Fishermen Talking outside Brøndum’s Hotel

Christian Krohg

1888 · Skagens Museum



Christian Krohg. Two fishermen talking on a bench in front of the stable wing of Brøndum's Hotel. Image credit: Christian Krohg. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The men turn slightly toward each other along the whitewashed wall. Windows, doorway and bench supply the scale of an ordinary building rather than a ceremonial setting for the encounter. Their company is carried by those small bodily adjustments; the image does not need to disclose the conversation's words.

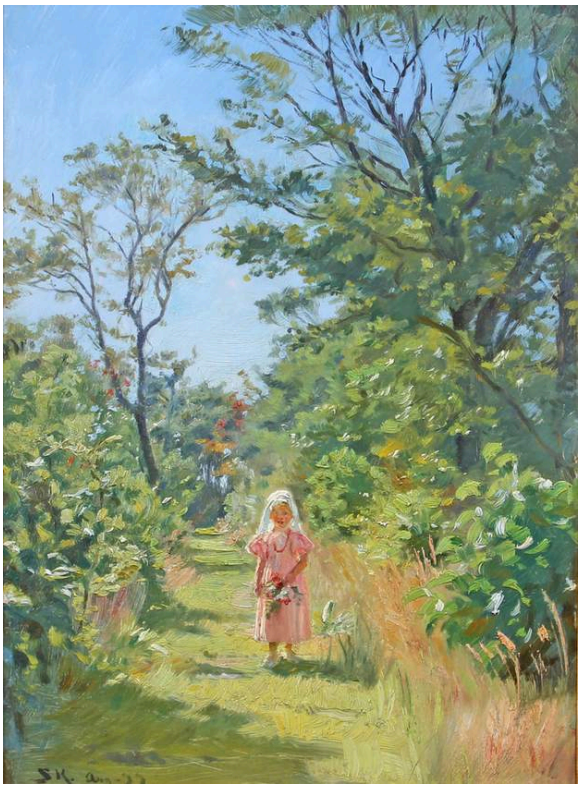
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SKM379

20 / 20

Vibeke Krøyer in the Plantation

P. S. Krøyer

1909 · Skagens Museum



Peder Severin Krøyer. Vibeke Krøyer in the plantation. Image credit: Peder Severin Krøyer. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The pink figure is small within the green path and surrounding growth, yet the colour keeps her from disappearing. Branches and grasses occupy much more space than the child. The portrait is therefore also a landscape in which a particular person has been located, rather than a likeness extracted from its environment.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SKM2087

More than one kind of blue

Compare an evening beach with Anna Ancher's blue room: a similar colour can organise an open coast or an enclosed interior. Keep each work's particular setting in view. This guide follows recorded works, not a fixed hanging; confirm current displays and the relevant museum venue before visiting.

Further reading

The Practice and Science of Drawing

Harold Speed · Read free · English

Speed’s account of tone and composition offers a way to compare the light in Anna Ancher’s rooms with the open-air groups by Krøyer and Björck. The book supplies practical vocabulary rather than a history of the Skagen colony.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

Artline · Skagens Museum: Masterpieces